

Ankur Sinha

Principal UX Designer · Human-AI Interaction · Toronto, ON

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SUMMARY

Engineer-turned-designer, 12+ years shipping enterprise SaaS across banking, supply chain, and cloud infrastructure. **Principal UX Designer at Oracle**, where I own the design end-to-end for cloud database operations in OCI — taking dangerous, expert-only tasks (encryption, key rotation, disaster-recovery failover) and turning them into safe, guided console flows a non-expert can run. I work at the design-engineering seam: I research, design, and prototype in code, then hand engineering a contract they can build against — not just Figma.

EXPERIENCE

Principal UX Designer — Oracle, Cloud Database Tooling · Feb 2020 – Present

Sole designer on Oracle's Database-as-a-Service (DBaaS) console operations in OCI. I own each flow end-to-end — user research with DBAs, information architecture, flows, high-fidelity specs, and working code prototypes — then support engineering through build.

- **Encryption, made safe.** Designed the console flows for Transparent Data Encryption (TDE) with OCI Vault/KMS — provisioning, host-wallet→KMS migration, and key rotation across VM and bare-metal. Treated *recovery cost* as the design axis: irreversible steps interrupt and confirm, so customers can encrypt production data without risking lockout.
- **PDB lifecycle in the console.** Brought pluggable-database management (DBCS/ExaCS/ExaCC) out of manual, host-only SSH work and into the OCI Console, SDK, and Terraform.
- **Disaster recovery you can trust.** Designed Cross-Region Autonomous Data Guard — standby creation, buddy-region selection, and automatic/manual failover — so applications reconnect seamlessly to the new primary during a region outage.
- Shipped supporting surfaces: Refreshable Clone, Autonomous Data Guard maintenance & patching, ADB time-zone updates, and Spatial Studio (DB Tools).

UX Designer / Product Strategist — Deloitte Touche Tohmatsu India · Apr 2018 – Feb 2020

Brought UCD process to enterprise channels (Salesforce, Supply Chain ERPs). Conducted end-to-end user-requirement analysis; iterated information architecture and reporting surfaces with stakeholders across product, engineering, QA, and clients.

Lead UX Designer — Snowtint Technologies · Sep 2016 – Mar 2018

Founded and led the company's first UX team. Built a group of interaction designers and researchers; owned production and delivery across web, social, and mobile properties; set strategic UX direction.

UX Designer (Jr → mid) — Rage Communication · Jun 2015 – Jul 2016

Banking and consumer projects (Citibank NA / India / Philippines, HSBC, Deutsche Bank, Vodafone, Unilever, CEAT, Quikr). Wireframes, interaction design, end-user interviews, client presentation.

INDEPENDENT PROJECTS & EXPLORATIONS

Self-directed, open-source builds — not client or employer work. How I learn the human-AI seam hands-on: I ship the design argument as working software, in evenings and weekends.

Helm — Real-time oversight of LLM agents

github.com/sinhaankur/Helm · [Live demo](#)

A prototype exploring how a human stays in the loop *while* an agent acts: every tool call previewed with intent, target, diff, and cost. Built around one idea — **reversibility (recovery cost), not "safety," is the policy axis**: auto-allow caps at reversible; irreversible steps always pause.

Sentinel — Embeddable inline oversight layer for AI tools

github.com/sinhaankur/Human-in-the-Loop · [Live demo](#)

A drop-in oversight-layer concept, prototyped **four ways** (React library, Chrome extension over ChatGPT, VS Code Copilot wrapper, Docker demo). Explores a calibrated-confidence vocabulary (Likely / Unsure / Low → exact % on hover), a distinct hallucination chip, and a verdict rail that blocks rubber-stamping once any claim is edited.

Recourse — Consumer AI as advocate against institutional loops

github.com/sinhaankur/Recourse · [Live demo](#)

A document-first workflow concept that helps people contest insurance denials with statute-anchored claims and a cadence engine that never lets a deadline slip. Explores flipping confidence language to action verbs (Settled / You verify / Ask a lawyer) and anchoring every claim to a real statute.

Other explorations

github.com/sinhaankur/GovLens — context-aware overlay for government portals (translation, usability scoring, a three-engine translation cascade). · github.com/sinhaankur/WatchTower — self-hosted deployment tooling (Python · Electron). · github.com/sinhaankur/ideal-giggle — offline-first multi-modal AI companion with a deterministic fallback.

HOW I WORK

- **I code my own prototypes** (React/TS, SwiftUI, Compose, Next.js) and hand off to engineering with the contract already in code — not just Figma.
 - **Design-systems thinking for AI surfaces**: calibrated language over raw percentages, reusable verdict / approval / audit shapes, one visual primitive for category-different failure modes.
 - **Reversibility, not "safety," is the policy axis** — recovery cost determines when a system must pause for the human.
 - **Outcome-driven over task-driven** — design for the result the user actually wants, then let them steer the system there.
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EDUCATION & CERTIFICATION

- **B.Tech, Computer Science** — BTLIT Bangalore, VTU · 2008 – 2013

- **HFI Certified Usability Analyst (CUA)**
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TOOLS

Figma · Code (React/TS, SwiftUI, Kotlin Compose, Next.js, Tauri, Electron) · Supabase / Prisma · OpenAPI · Style Dictionary · Anthropic / OpenAI / Ollama SDKs · face-api.js · Adobe XD / Photoshop